

Wheels Rent A Car

Lebanon — Customer Website

Product Requirements Document, UX Flows & Sitemap

Phase 1 — Customer-facing booking website

Version 1.0 • Prepared by Saiko Digital

Document	Wheels Rent A Car — PRD, UX & Sitemap
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Saiko Digital — Toni Haidamous
Audience	Internal team, development agency, design partners
Scope	Phase 1 only — customer-facing site (English)
Out of scope	Native mobile app, marketing automation, multilingual (Phase 2+)

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary

This document defines the Phase 1 scope, user experience, sitemap, and functional requirements for the new Wheels Rent A Car Lebanon website. It expands on the original PRD by translating high-level goals into screen-by-screen UX, a detailed information architecture, low-fidelity wireframe descriptions, and a Lebanon-localized feature set.

The site replaces the existing wheelsrentacar.com.lb experience with a modern, conversion-focused platform inspired by category leaders Sixt and Avis for UI patterns, and Advanced Rent A Car for Lebanon-specific localization. The platform must surface real-time inventory and pricing from Wheels' internal management system, and reduce manual booking handling to near zero.

Phase 1 deliberately excludes the operations admin panel, native mobile apps, and marketplace integrations. Localization is English-only at launch, with the architecture prepared for Arabic and French in Phase 2.

Strategic positioning

- Premium, touristic, lifestyle-oriented brand voice.
- Best-in-class booking UX: minimum clicks from landing to confirmed reservation.
- Lebanon-native: Beirut Airport (BEY) pickup, address delivery, WhatsApp assistance, cash and local bank-transfer options.
- Fully integrated with Wheels' fleet and operations system — single source of truth.

2. Goals & Success Metrics

2.1 Business goals

- Increase online booking conversion rate by replacing the legacy site with a frictionless flow.
- Eliminate manual handling for standard reservations through end-to-end system integration.
- Position Wheels as Lebanon's premium, tourist-friendly car rental brand.
- Capture demand from Beirut Airport arrivals and inbound tourists.
- Reduce drop-off in the booking funnel through transparent pricing and clear copy.

2.2 Phase 1 KPIs

KPI	Definition	Target (Year 1)
Booking conversion rate	Sessions with completed booking / total sessions	≥ 4.5%
Booking-flow drop-off	Users who start /book and don't reach confirmation	≤ 55%
Time to first booking step	Landing → first interaction with search bar	< 12s median
Manual booking handling	Bookings requiring human intervention pre-pickup	< 5%
Mobile share of bookings	Bookings completed on mobile device	≥ 55%
WhatsApp-assisted conversions	Sessions that touch WhatsApp & convert	Track baseline
Lighthouse performance (mobile)	Median across listing, PDP, checkout	≥ 85
Booking sync error rate	Failed / total real-time syncs to internal system	< 0.5%
NPS post-booking	Email survey after pickup	≥ 50

3. Target Users & Personas

Phase 1 prioritizes three primary personas. The site must visibly serve each of them on the homepage, in navigation, and in the booking flow.

3.1 Persona — Inbound Tourist (Primary)

Field	Value
Profile	International visitor, 28–55, arriving via BEY, 1–14 day rental
Devices	Mobile-first (iOS and Android), often on hotel Wi-Fi or international roaming
Top jobs	Find a car for airport pickup; understand insurance; pay confidently in USD or by card
Pain points	Hidden fees, unclear deposits, language friction, distrust of local operators
Site implications	Prominent BEY pickup option; insurance tier comparison; English-first; visible trust badges; flight-number capture

3.2 Persona — Local Lebanese Renter (Primary)

Field	Value
Profile	Lebanese resident, 25–50, weekend trip, replacement vehicle, or longer-term need
Devices	Mostly mobile; comfortable on WhatsApp
Top jobs	Quick reservation; pay cash or by local transfer; pickup from a city branch
Pain points	Card payment friction, deposit holds; rigid booking forms; slow confirmation
Site implications	Cash + bank-transfer (OMT/Whish) checkout path; WhatsApp completion option; Lebanese phone format default

3.3 Persona — Business Traveler / Corporate User (Primary)

Field	Value
Profile	Executive or SME, multi-day rental, often longer term, may need chauffeur
Devices	Desktop and mobile; expects emailed invoice
Top jobs	Reliable car, on-time delivery, billing to company, optional driver

Field	Value
Pain points	Receipt/invoice friction, unclear chauffeur booking, no monthly pricing
Site implications	Long-term rental tier, Chauffeur add-on, Corporate landing page, invoice-ready confirmation email

3.4 Secondary persona — Expat / Returning Diaspora

Treated as a sub-segment of Inbound Tourist; same flows but more likely to choose monthly tiers and address delivery to family addresses.

4. Information Architecture & Sitemap

The site is organized around the booking task, with discovery and trust-building content arranged to support conversion. The sitemap below covers all Phase 1 pages.

4.1 Top-level navigation

- Vehicles — fleet browse, category landings, vehicle detail pages
- Locations — Beirut Airport, branch locations, address delivery
- Long-term Rental — monthly packages and multi-month tiers
- Chauffeur — with-driver service
- Corporate — B2B landing page with enquiry form
- About — brand story, fleet philosophy, team
- Help — FAQ, rental terms, insurance, payment, cancellation
- Contact — branch list, WhatsApp, phone, form

4.2 Full sitemap

See visual sitemap diagram on the next page. Detailed page list:

URL	Page	Access
/	Home	Public
/vehicles	Fleet — all vehicles, filterable	Public
/vehicles/[category]	Category landing (e.g. economy, SUV, luxury)	Public
/vehicles/[slug]	Vehicle Detail Page (PDP)	Public
/book	Entry redirect to /book/select-vehicle if dates provided	Public
/book/select-vehicle	Search results with sticky search bar	Public
/book/extras	Add-ons selection (baby seats, GPS, etc.)	Public
/book/protection	Insurance / protection package tiers	Public
/book/checkout	Customer info + payment method	Public
/book/confirmation/[ref]	Booking confirmation, receipt	Public
/locations	All locations overview	Public
/locations/beirut-airport	BEY pickup detail	Public
/locations/[branch]	City branch detail page	Public
/long-term	Monthly rental landing	Public
/chauffeur	With-driver service landing	Public

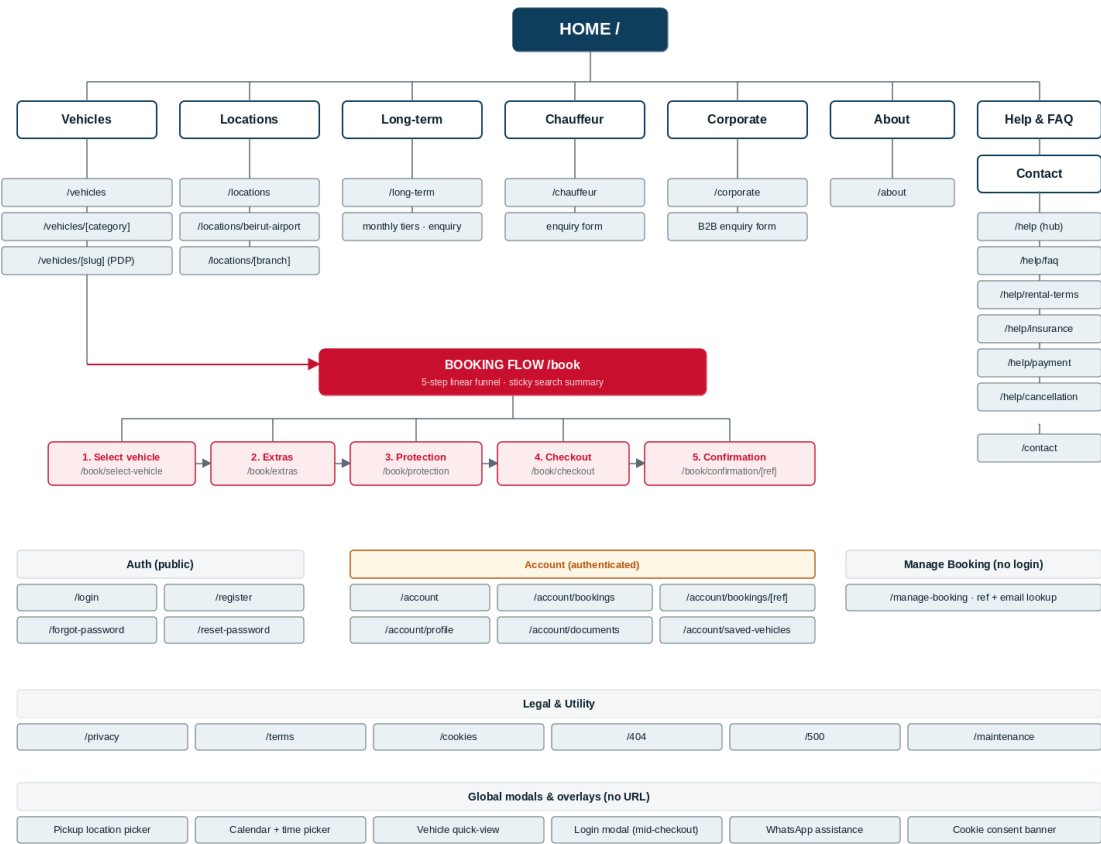
URL	Page	Access
/corporate	Corporate / B2B landing + enquiry form	Public
/about	Brand story	Public
/help	Support hub	Public
/help/faq	FAQ	Public
/help/rental-terms	Rental terms	Public
/help/insurance-and-coverage	Insurance explainer	Public
/help/payment-and-deposits	Payment & deposit policy	Public
/help/cancellation-policy	Cancellation policy	Public
/contact	Contact page	Public
/manage-booking	Lookup by ref + email (no login)	Public
/login	Sign in	Public
/register	Create account	Public
/forgot-password	Password recovery request	Public
/reset-password	Password reset	Public
/account	Account dashboard	Authenticated
/account/bookings	Booking history list	Authenticated
/account/bookings/[ref]	Booking detail	Authenticated
/account/profile	Profile + preferences	Authenticated
/account/documents	Driver's licence + ID upload	Authenticated
/account/saved-vehicles	Wishlist / saved cars	Authenticated
/privacy	Privacy policy	Public
/terms	Terms of service	Public
/cookies	Cookie policy	Public
/404, /500, /maintenance	Error & utility pages	Public

4.3 Visual sitemap

The diagram below shows the complete information architecture for Phase 1, including the booking funnel (red), authenticated areas (amber), public sub-pages (light), and global components (no URL).

Wheels Rent A Car — Sitemap

Phase 1 · Customer-facing site · English



Legend: ■ Root □ Top-level page □ Sub-page / route ■ Booking funnel □ Booking step ■ Authenticated area

Notes: Guest checkout is supported throughout the funnel. The floating WhatsApp button is global. Account is optional and can be created in 1-click on the confirmation screen.

Figure 1 — Phase 1 sitemap. High-resolution version available as sitemap.png in the project assets folder.

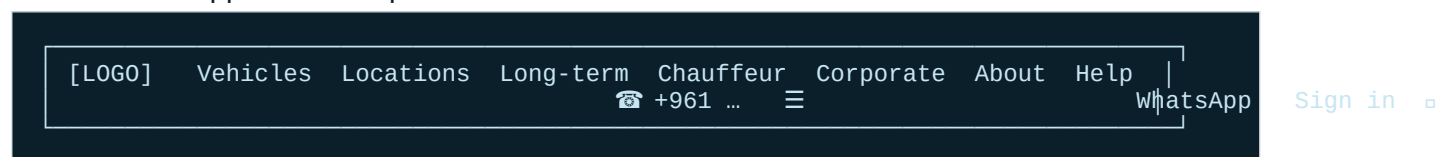
5. Global UI System

Components shared across every page. Establishing them once ensures consistency and reduces design and dev cost downstream.

5.1 Header

Sticky on desktop, collapsing/transparent over hero on home, solid on all other pages.

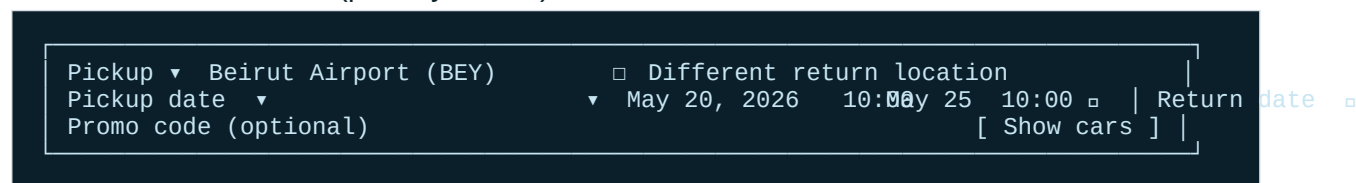
- Left: Wheels logo (links home)
- Center: primary nav — Vehicles, Locations, Long-term, Chauffeur, Corporate, About, Help
- Right: phone number (+961, click-to-call), WhatsApp icon, Manage Booking link, Sign In / Register
- Mobile: hamburger menu opens full-screen drawer with same nav, plus phone + WhatsApp CTAs at top



5.2 Persistent Search Bar

The most important component on the site. Inspired by Sixt's compact horizontal bar and Advanced's pickup-type picker.

- Pickup location dropdown — categorical: Beirut Airport (BEY), City Branches (Hamra, Downtown, Dbayeh, ...), Address Delivery, With Driver
- Different return location toggle (default off) → reveals Return Location dropdown
- Pickup date + time picker (24h format)
- Return date + time picker
- Promo code (collapsible)
- CTA: 'Show cars' (primary accent)



5.3 Footer

- Column 1 — Wheels: About, Locations, Fleet, Long-term, Chauffeur, Corporate
- Column 2 — Help: FAQ, Rental Terms, Insurance, Payment & Deposits, Cancellation
- Column 3 — Contact: Phone, WhatsApp, Email, Branch addresses
- Column 4 — Trust: Trustpilot/Google rating widget, payment method icons, association badges

- Bottom strip: copyright, language switcher (EN; AR/FR placeholder), social icons, legal links

5.4 Floating WhatsApp button

Persistent on every page, bottom-right. Tap opens WhatsApp Web/app to a Wheels-managed number with a context-aware pre-filled message (e.g., on PDP: 'Hi, I'm interested in renting the Toyota Yaris from May 20–25').

5.5 Cookie & consent banner

Bottom-anchored on first visit. Two clear options: Accept all / Manage preferences. GDPR-style — useful since the site will be visited from EU markets.

6. Page-by-Page UX & Wireframes

For each page below: purpose, content blocks, layout description, primary actions, edge cases, and a low-fidelity wireframe sketch.

6.1 Home — /

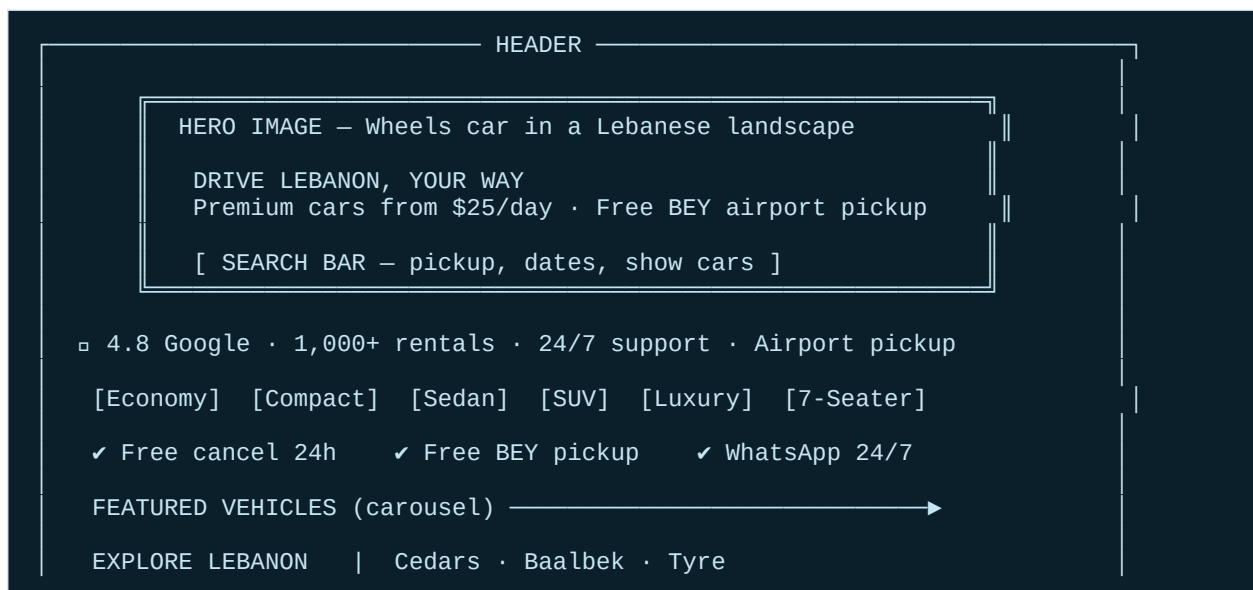
Purpose

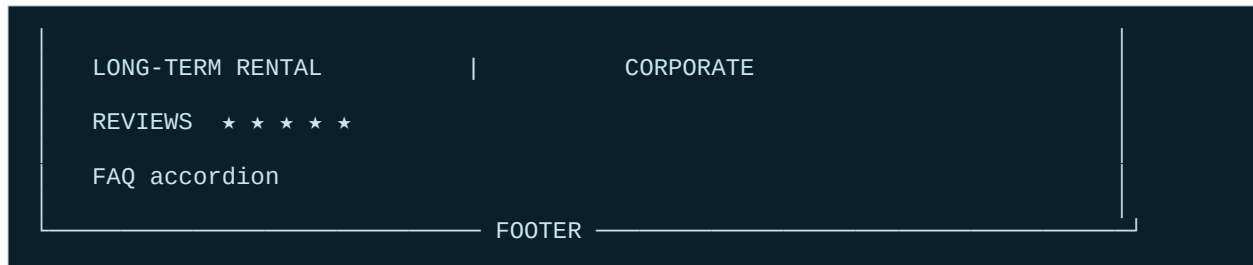
Convert intent traffic into bookings within seconds, while introducing premium brand to discovery traffic.

Content blocks (in order)

1. Hero with persistent Search Bar overlaid on a full-bleed image of a Wheels vehicle in a Lebanese setting (e.g., Raouché, Cedars, Downtown Beirut).
2. Trust strip: '4.8★ on Google • 1,000+ rentals • 24/7 support • Airport pickup' — single horizontal row, mobile-scrollable.
3. Featured categories: 6 large category cards (Economy, Compact, Sedan, SUV, Luxury, 7-seater).
4. Why Wheels: 3-up value props — 'Free cancellation up to 24h', 'Free Beirut Airport pickup', 'WhatsApp support 24/7'.
5. Featured vehicles carousel (6–10 cards).
6. Tourist module: 'Explore Lebanon with Wheels' — 3 destination cards (Cedars, Baalbek, Tyre) with suggested itineraries linking to relevant fleet category.
7. Long-term + Corporate dual CTA strip.
8. Reviews carousel (Trustpilot / Google).
9. FAQ accordion (top 6 questions).
10. Footer.

Layout — desktop





Edge cases

- If user lands with UTM/promo, pre-fill promo code field and surface a banner above the search bar.
- If user has an in-progress booking saved in localStorage, show a small 'Resume your search' chip near the hero.

6.2 Fleet — /vehicles & /vehicles/[category]

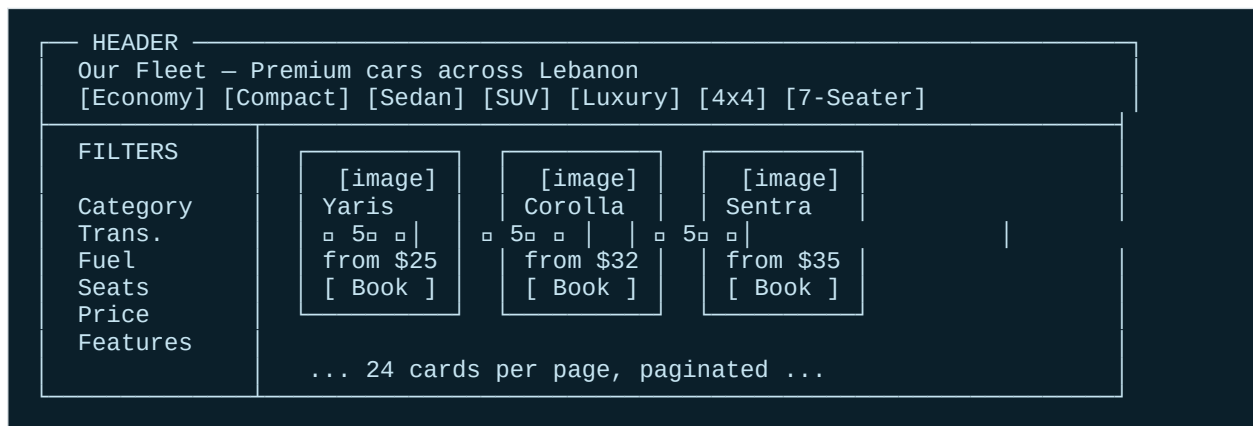
Purpose

Discovery surface for users browsing without dates set. Once dates are entered, the page transitions visually to the Search Results pattern (see 6.4).

Content blocks

11. Page hero: title, short description, optional category-specific imagery.
12. Category chips strip — Economy, Compact, Sedan, SUV, Luxury, 4x4, 7-seater, Convertible.
13. Filter sidebar (left, desktop) / Filter sheet (mobile): category, transmission, fuel type, seats, price range, features (Bluetooth, GPS, Cruise).
14. Vehicle card grid (3 columns desktop, 1 column mobile). Each card: image, model + 'or similar', category, key specs row (seats / transmission / fuel / bags), 'from \$X/day', primary CTA 'View & Book'.
15. Pagination or infinite scroll (24 per page).
16. CTA strip at bottom: 'Need help choosing? Chat on WhatsApp.'

Layout — desktop



6.3 Vehicle Detail Page — /vehicles/[slug]

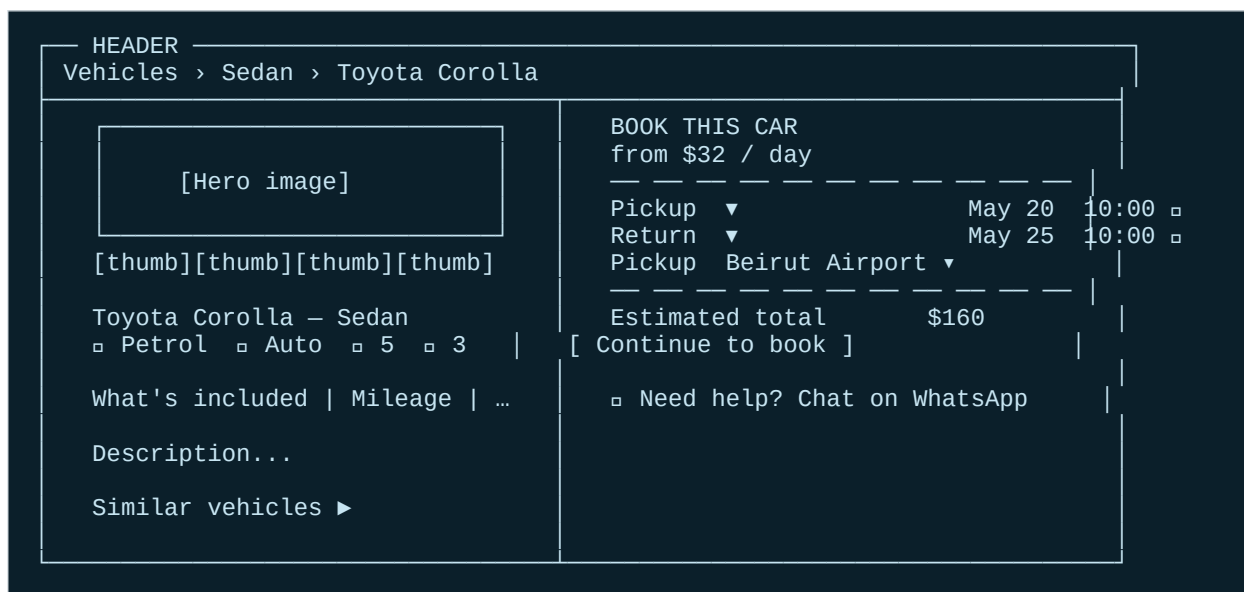
Purpose

Sell the specific vehicle and start the booking. Reachable from listing, search results, featured carousel, or direct link.

Content blocks

17. Breadcrumb: Vehicles > Category > Model
18. Image gallery (left, 60%): hero image + 4 thumbnails, lightbox on click. Show real Wheels-shot photos where possible.
19. Booking summary card (right, sticky): from \$X/day, mini date picker pre-filled if dates known, total estimate, CTA 'Continue to book'.
20. Spec strip: seats, transmission, fuel type, bags, AC, doors, year.
21. 'What's included' tabs: Fuel policy, Insurance, Mileage, Driver requirements.
22. Description — short paragraph + bullet feature list.
23. Similar vehicles row.
24. FAQ accordion (vehicle-specific + booking).

Wireframe — desktop



Edge cases

- If selected dates have no availability for this exact model: card flips to show 'Not available — see similar' with one-click swap to a similar car.
- If price increases between PDP load and booking start (rate change), show a soft warning at /book/select-vehicle entry.

6.4 Booking Flow — Step-by-step

The booking flow is a 5-step linear funnel with a persistent stepper at the top and a sticky summary panel on the right (desktop) or expandable bottom sheet (mobile). Inspired by Avis' clean stepper and Sixt's sticky booking overview panel.

Stepper (always visible)

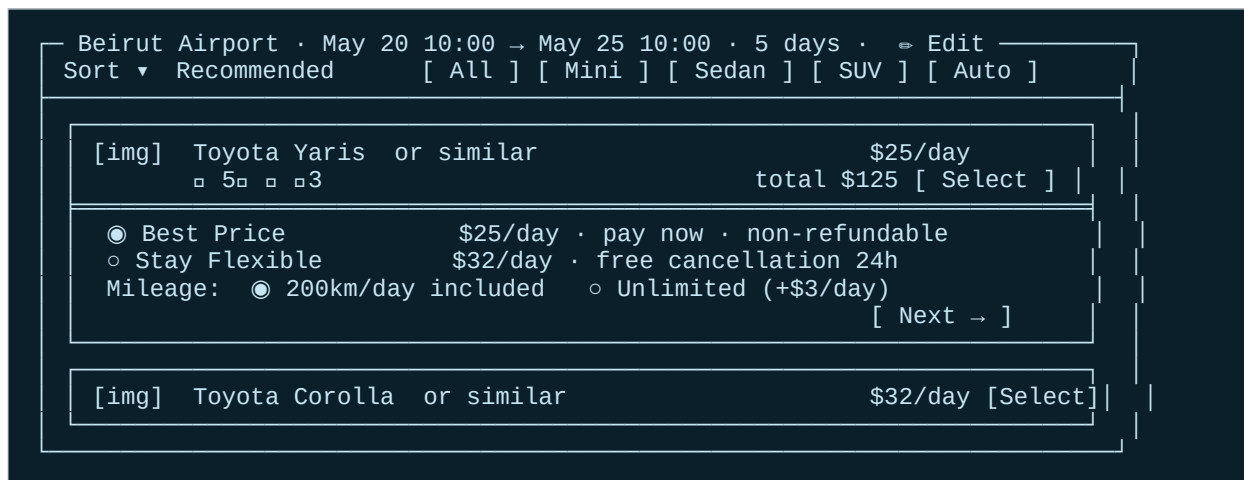
1. Select vehicle → 2. Extras → 3. Protection → 4. Checkout → 5. Confirmation

Steps 1–4 are clickable to go back; step 5 is read-only.

Step 1 — /book/select-vehicle

Search results page. Date/location bar pinned at the top, vehicles listed below.

- Sticky filter bar: sort (Recommended / Price low–high / Price high–low), filter chips (Mini, Sedan, SUV, Luxury, Auto only).
- Vehicle card list — 1 column on mobile, 2–3 on desktop. Each card: image, name + 'or similar', specs strip, price/day + total, primary CTA 'Select'.
- On select: card expands inline (Sixt pattern) to show rate options — 'Best Price' (pay now, non-refundable) vs 'Stay Flexible' (free cancellation up to 24h, +\$X/day) vs Mileage choices (default Xkm/day, Unlimited +\$Y/day). User picks one and confirms with 'Next'.



Step 2 — /book/extras

List of optional extras with toggle/qty controls. Inspired by Sixt's clean toggle list and Advanced's flat list with 'Add' buttons.

- Categories: Driver & access (Additional driver, Underage driver fee), Comfort (Baby seat, Booster seat, Child seat, GPS), Connectivity (4G WiFi hotspot), Convenience (Refuelling service, Roadside assistance+), Lebanon-specific (Adopt-a-tree / CO₂ offset \$5/rental — optional sustainability angle).
- Each row: icon, name, short copy + 'Details' link (modal), price/day or per-rental, qty stepper or on/off toggle.
- Sticky right panel: Booking overview (vehicle, dates, location, running total).

Step 3 — /book/protection

Insurance / damage protection presented as 3 tiered cards (Avis & Sixt pattern). Tier comparison must be scannable at a glance.

- Tier 1 — Basic Protection (default, included). Deductible \$X.
- Tier 2 — Smart Protection (most popular, badge). Reduced deductible. +\$Y/day.
- Tier 3 — All Inclusive (zero deductible, full peace of mind). +\$Z/day.
- Each card shows: tier name, deductible amount, included items checklist, price, 'Select' button.
- Below the cards: short FAQ on insurance, link to /help/insurance-and-coverage.

Step 4 — /book/checkout

Customer info, payment method, terms. Single page; no step splits — Avis pattern.

- Driver details: First name, Last name, Email, Mobile (LB country code default +961, with full international support), Date of birth (must satisfy minimum age for vehicle), Driver's licence number, Licence issue date, Licence expiry.
- Lebanese address vs international toggle — collapses unnecessary fields.
- Flight number (optional) for airport pickups — auto-shown only if pickup = Beirut Airport.
- Delivery address (optional) — only if pickup = Address Delivery.
- Payment method radio: Credit/Debit card · Cash on pickup · Bank transfer (OMT/Whish/local bank).
- Each method reveals contextual sub-form / instructions (see Section 7).
- Mandatory deposit / pre-authorisation explainer panel.
- Promo code field (collapsible).
- Marketing consent checkbox (off by default).
- Terms & conditions checkbox (required).
- Sticky summary panel right: vehicle, dates, location, line items, total.
- Primary CTA at bottom: 'Pay & confirm' (card) or 'Confirm reservation' (cash / bank transfer).

Step 5 — /book/confirmation/[ref]

Successful booking screen. Email + WhatsApp message also sent.

- Header: 'Your booking is confirmed' · big booking reference, copy-to-clipboard.
- Vehicle, pickup, return, and total summary card.
- Next steps checklist: 'Bring your driver's licence', 'Have credit card ready for deposit', 'We'll WhatsApp you 24h before pickup'.
- Add to Google / Apple Calendar buttons (.ics).
- 'Modify booking' / 'Cancel booking' inline actions.
- Cross-sell: 'Need a chauffeur?' or 'Add insurance' if not selected.
- CTA: 'Create an account in 1 click' (pre-filled from booking).

6.5 Locations — /locations & /locations/[branch]

Hub page lists all branches as cards on a map (Mapbox or Google Maps). Each branch detail page covers: address, hours, parking instructions, photos, branch-specific phone/WhatsApp, embedded map, fleet typically available.

BEY airport page is the most important — must surface 'Free pickup at terminal', meeting point instructions, sample 'how it works' steps, flight tracking note.

6.6 Long-term Rental — /long-term

Tiered pricing comparison: 1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 12 months. Each tier shows discounted day rate, included km, included services.

Lead form: name, mobile, vehicle preference, start month — sales team follows up. Optionally hits same booking flow but with monthly pricing.

6.7 Chauffeur — /chauffeur

Service marketing page: hourly + daily + half-day rates, vehicle classes (Sedan / Premium SUV / Van), languages spoken by drivers, sample itineraries (airport transfer, day-trip Cedars, wedding transport).

CTA: 'Request chauffeur' opens a focused enquiry form (date, hours, pickup, drop-off, passengers, language).

6.8 Corporate — /corporate

B2B landing page. Value props (volume pricing, single invoice, account manager, monthly billing). Logos of current corporate clients. Lead capture form.

6.9 About — /about

Brand story, founding, fleet philosophy, sustainability commitments (if any), team photos, branch locations highlighted on map.

6.10 Help & FAQ — /help/*

Hub page with 6 categories. Each subpage uses an accordion of common questions plus a short intro. Search bar at top of hub. Persistent 'Still need help? Chat on WhatsApp' card.

6.11 Contact — /contact

Branch list, phones, WhatsApp, email, contact form (name, email, phone, subject dropdown, message). Map of all branches. Office hours.

6.12 Account & Manage Booking

Account dashboard shows upcoming + past bookings, profile, documents, saved vehicles.

Booking detail page (Sixt pattern): vehicle card, itinerary, included protection, add-ons, payment information, important info (deposit return), invoice download, contact branch link.

Manage Booking is a no-login lookup: enter booking ref + email, see booking detail with edit/cancel actions (subject to policy).

7. Lebanon-Specific Feature Deep Dive

Three localizations differentiate Wheels in the Lebanese market. Each is treated as a first-class flow rather than an afterthought.

7.1 WhatsApp integration

Touchpoints

- Floating WhatsApp button (every page) — context-aware pre-filled message.
- Header WhatsApp icon.
- Vehicle Detail Page CTA: 'Ask about this car on WhatsApp'.
- Mid-checkout assistance prompt — appears after 30s idle on /book/checkout: 'Need help completing your booking? Chat with our team' (Advanced pattern).
- Confirmation screen + email — 'Save our WhatsApp: +961 ...'
- 24h pre-pickup reminder via WhatsApp Business API.
- Post-rental review request via WhatsApp.

Implementation requirements

- WhatsApp Business API account (Twilio, MessageBird, or Meta Cloud API) with a single Wheels Business number.
- Pre-filled message templates per touchpoint (PDP, cart abandon, generic).
- Internal routing inbox so multiple agents can respond — recommend using 360dialog or Respond.io.
- Opt-in capture in checkout: 'Send my booking updates via WhatsApp ☐ (default on for LB numbers).

7.2 Cash on pickup & local bank transfer

Payment methods supported

Method	When available	Deposit handling	User experience
Credit/Debit card	Always	Pre-auth hold on card at pickup	Standard flow — instant confirm
Cash on pickup (USD or LBP)	Toggle on per branch / category	Cash deposit at counter	Confirm reservation immediately, branch contacts to verify
Bank transfer	If pickup $\geq$ 48h away	Full payment before pickup	Show bank details + reference, upload proof of transfer, status pending until confirmed
OMT / Whish / Bob Finance	Local Lebanese only	Cash equivalent — full payment	Show payment code + branch, status pending until confirmed

Checkout UX

Payment method radio set on /book/checkout. Selected method reveals contextual block:

- Card: standard card form.
- Cash: copy explaining 'Bring USD or LBP at pickup. Refundable security deposit required at counter.'
- Bank transfer: bank details (Bank of Beirut / BLOM / etc.), reference number = booking ref, file upload field for proof, note that booking is pending until proof is received.
- OMT/Whish: instructions + payment code, file upload optional.

Booking states

Add a Pending state to the standard Confirmed/Cancelled set. Cash and bank-transfer bookings sit in Pending until verified by ops, and the user sees 'Pending verification' on confirmation screen + a clear next step.

7.3 Beirut Airport (BEY) pickup, address delivery & chauffeur

Pickup type categories

- Beirut Airport (BEY) — meeting at Wheels desk / kerbside; free.
- City Branch — pick from list (Hamra, Downtown, Dbayeh, ...); free.
- Address Delivery — driver delivers car to user's address (hotel, residence); fee zone-based.
- Chauffeur — separate flow on /chauffeur, with driver included.

Address delivery UX

- Search bar pickup dropdown shows 'Address Delivery' as an option.
- On select: address autocomplete (Google Places or OpenCage), delivery-fee preview based on zone.
- Same return option (return to address) toggle.
- Checkout shows delivery fee as a separate line item.
- Confirmation includes a 'Where will the car be delivered?' map and contact info for the delivery driver.

Airport pickup specifics

- Flight number field appears on /book/checkout when pickup = BEY.
- Confirmation explains meeting point clearly (e.g., 'Meet our agent at the BEY arrivals hall, exit B') with a photo and map.
- Ops uses flight number to track ETA; we can extend the held vehicle if flight is delayed (rule: up to 90 min free).

8. Functional Requirements

8.1 Real-time inventory & pricing

- Vehicle availability MUST reflect internal management system in near real-time (≤ 60 s lag).
- Pricing rules (base rate, seasonal multipliers, length-of-rental discounts, promo codes) MUST be calculated server-side with the internal system as the source of truth.
- If a vehicle's price changes mid-funnel, system MUST recalculate at /book/checkout entry and warn the user if total changes by $> 1\%$.
- If a vehicle becomes unavailable mid-funnel, user MUST be redirected to /book/select-vehicle with a non-blocking notice and the same dates pre-applied.

8.2 Booking creation

- Successful checkout creates a reservation in the internal system in the same request that returns confirmation to the user.
- If the sync to internal system fails: card is NOT charged, user sees a friendly retry screen, and ops is alerted.
- Booking reference format: 'WRC-YYMMDD-XXXX' (4-char alphanumeric).
- Confirmation email sent within 30s of booking; WhatsApp message within 60s if opted in.

8.3 Search & filters

- Filter changes update results without full page reload (client-side fetch).
- URL must reflect filter state (shareable links): /vehicles?category=suv&trans=auto&minSeats=5
- Sort options: Recommended (default), Price low-high, Price high-low, Newest, Largest car.

8.4 Account & guest checkout

- Guest checkout is supported throughout — account creation is optional.
- Account creation can be 1-click from the confirmation page (account uses email + sets password).
- Authenticated users have pre-filled checkout (driver details, licence).
- Driver licence and ID upload supported on /account/documents — accepted on subsequent bookings.

8.5 Manage booking

- /manage-booking — booking ref + email lookup → booking detail page with same actions as authenticated.
- Edit pickup/return time within policy (free up to 24h before pickup).
- Cancel booking — refund logic per /help/cancellation-policy; show refund preview before confirm.

- Add extras / change protection tier post-booking (re-charges or asks for additional payment at counter).

8.6 Notifications

Trigger	Channel(s)	Content
Booking confirmed	Email + WhatsApp (if opted)	Booking ref, vehicle, dates, total, what to bring
Booking pending verification	Email	Reference, what to do next, contact info
Payment received (bank transfer/OMT)	Email + WhatsApp	Confirmation
24h pre-pickup	WhatsApp + Email	Reminder, meeting point, contact
Pickup ready / car delivered	WhatsApp	Acknowledgement
Return reminder (1h before)	WhatsApp	Where to return
Post-rental review request	WhatsApp + Email	1-tap rating link
Booking cancelled	Email	Refund summary
Failed sync (internal)	Slack/email to ops	Error details, booking ref

8.7 Search engine optimization

- SEO-friendly URLs (kebab-case, semantic).
- Per-page meta titles and descriptions, Open Graph tags.
- Structured data: Organization, LocalBusiness (per branch), Product (per vehicle), FAQPage.
- Sitemap.xml auto-generated; robots.txt managed.
- Canonical tags on category and listing pages to avoid duplicate-content issues.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

9.1 Performance

Metric	Target
Largest Contentful Paint (mobile, 3G)	< 2.5s
First Input Delay	< 100ms
Cumulative Layout Shift	< 0.1
Time to Interactive (mobile, 4G)	< 4s
Booking flow page transitions	< 800ms perceived

9.2 Security

- HTTPS enforced site-wide (HSTS, redirect).
- PCI DSS-compliant card handling — payments tokenized via PSP (Areeba, Adyen, Stripe — to be confirmed).
- CSRF protection on all state-changing endpoints.
- Rate limiting on auth and booking endpoints.
- Personal data encryption at rest.
- Logging of admin actions; no PII in client-side logs.

9.3 Accessibility

- WCAG 2.1 AA target.
- Keyboard-navigable booking flow (no mouse required).
- Focus states visible; semantic HTML; skip-to-content link.
- Image alt text on all vehicle and content images.
- Colour-contrast ratio $\geq 4.5:1$ for body text, $\geq 3:1$ for large text.

9.4 Reliability

- Target uptime 99.9%.
- Graceful degradation if internal system is unreachable: show cached fleet, disable booking with a clear message + WhatsApp/phone fallback.
- Daily database backups; weekly restoration test.

9.5 Browser & device support

- Latest 2 versions of Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Edge.
- iOS Safari 15+, Chrome Android last 2 years.
- Mobile-first responsive design at 360, 768, 1024, 1440 breakpoints.

10. Technical Requirements

10.1 Architecture

- Modern web stack — recommend Next.js (React) on Vercel or similar managed host for performance, SEO and DX.
- Headless CMS for content (vehicles content, blog if any, FAQ, locations) — recommend Sanity or Strapi.
- API integration layer between the website and Wheels' internal management system. Webhooks preferred over polling for inventory updates.
- Search/availability service — call internal system; cache responses for ≤ 60 s with cache-bust on write.
- Payment via Areeba (LB-friendly) primary, with optional fallback PSP.
- WhatsApp Business API via 360dialog or Meta Cloud.
- Email via Mailgun / Postmark / Resend.
- Analytics: GA4, Meta Pixel, Hotjar (Q1 only), server-side conversion API.

10.2 Environments

- development → staging → production with sanitised data in non-prod.
- CI/CD pipeline (GitHub Actions). Preview deploys on every PR.

10.3 Observability

- Frontend error monitoring (Sentry).
- Synthetic monitoring on /book/checkout (every 5 min).
- Sync failure alerting to Slack #wheels-ops.

11. Edge Cases & Error States

Scenario	User experience
No vehicles available for the selected dates	Empty state with: 'No cars available for these dates. Try a wider window.' + suggested alternative dates ± 2 days.
Vehicle becomes unavailable while in funnel	Soft redirect to /book/select-vehicle with toast: 'That car was just booked — here are similar options.'
Internal management system unreachable	Disable booking; show banner: 'Online booking is temporarily unavailable. Reach us on WhatsApp +961 ...' Cached browse still works.
Card payment fails	Inline error on card form, suggest retry or switch to Cash / Bank transfer methods.
Bank transfer proof not uploaded after 24h	Auto-cancel booking with email + WhatsApp notice; re-book friendly link.
Underage driver	Block selection of restricted categories with explainer copy and link to /help/rental-terms.
Foreign licence with non-Latin characters	Allow free-text licence number; passport upload required at counter.
Promo code invalid / expired	Inline message; do not block continuing without promo.
404 on a vehicle URL	Show similar vehicles in the same category.
Slow internet on mobile	Skeleton loaders for cards; image lazy-loading; minimum interactive shell < 1s.

12. Acceptance Criteria (Phase 1)

- A user can complete a booking from landing page to confirmation in ≤ 90 seconds on a typical mobile connection.
- All bookings created on the website appear in the internal management system within 60 seconds.
- Cash, bank transfer, and card payment methods are all functional and produce valid Pending or Confirmed bookings as appropriate.
- Beirut Airport pickup, City Branch pickup, and Address Delivery are all selectable in the search bar and produce correct line items.
- Floating WhatsApp button is present on every page, opens correct number, and pre-fills context-aware message.
- Confirmation screen and email contain booking ref, vehicle, dates, location, total, and meeting instructions.
- Manage Booking lookup with valid ref + email returns booking details and supports edit/cancel within policy.
- Lighthouse mobile scores: Performance ≥ 85 , Accessibility ≥ 95 , SEO ≥ 95 on home, listing, PDP, and checkout.
- WCAG 2.1 AA pass on home, listing, PDP, and checkout (verified with axe-core).
- All Phase 1 pages defined in the sitemap (Section 4) are live, indexable, and pass schema-validator.

13. Out of Scope (Phase 2+)

- Native mobile applications (iOS / Android).
- Arabic and French localization (architecture should be ready, but content is not in Phase 1).
- Loyalty program / Wheels Rewards.
- Marketplace integrations (Booking.com, Rentalcars, Expedia).
- Marketing automation platform (Klaviyo / HubSpot integration).
- Telematics / live vehicle tracking on the customer side.
- In-app digital licence / ID verification (Phase 2 — Onfido or similar).
- Operations admin panel deep redesign (Phase 1 assumes existing internal system is sufficient).

14. Appendix

14.1 Component library (suggested)

All UI patterns should be built once and re-used. Suggested component inventory for Phase 1:

Component	Used on
Header (sticky)	All pages
Mobile drawer nav	All pages (mobile)
Search bar (compact + expanded)	Home hero, listing top, PDP sidebar
Location dropdown	Search bar
Date+time picker	Search bar, PDP
Vehicle card (listing)	Listing, search results, featured carousel
Vehicle card (selected/expanded)	Search results — Sixt rate selector pattern
Tier comparison cards	Protection step
Add-on row toggle	Extras step
Sticky booking summary panel	All booking steps (desktop)
Bottom-sheet booking summary	All booking steps (mobile)
Stepper	Booking flow
Form inputs (text, dropdown, file)	Checkout, account, contact
Phone input with country code	Checkout, account
Payment method radio + reveal	Checkout
Toast / Banner notice	All pages
Modal / Lightbox	Vehicle gallery, add-on details, login
FAQ accordion	Help, Home, PDP
Map embed	Locations, branch detail, contact
WhatsApp floating button	All pages
Trust badges row	Home, Footer, Checkout

Component	Used on
Empty state	Listing no-results, account empty
Error boundary screen	404, 500, sync failure

14.2 Glossary

Term	Definition
BEY	Beirut–Rafic Hariri International Airport (IATA code).
PDP	Product / Vehicle Detail Page.
PSP	Payment Service Provider.
Pre-auth	Card pre-authorisation hold for security deposit.
OMT / Whish / Bob Finance	Lebanese cash-and-transfer networks used widely for in-country payments.
Pending booking	Reservation created but awaiting payment verification (cash / bank transfer).
Or similar	Industry term: the actual delivered car may be a comparable model in the same category.

14.3 References

- Sixt — sixt.com (UI/UX reference: search bar, rate selector, tier protection, sticky summary)
- Avis — avis.com (stepper pattern, protection cards, checkout layout)
- Advanced Rent A Car — advancedcarrental.com (Lebanon localization: pickup categories, WhatsApp prompt, Pay Now / Pay Later, flight number)
- Existing site — wheelsrentacar.com.lb (data only, not design reference)

14.4 Document control

Field	Value
Author	Saiko Digital — Toni Haidamous
Reviewers (Wheels)	TBD
Reviewers (Saiko)	TBD
Status	Draft for review
Next review	After stakeholder walkthrough